

Tuesday, 14 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

30° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

29° 14°

MANCHESTER

Partly cloudy

27° 14°

GLASGOW

Mostly clear

22° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 The UK heatwave is set to intensify this week, with experts warning of rising temperatures and humidity.

After a brief respite, many parts of the country will see the mercury climb again, as wildfires continue to burn in several areas. Fire services are urging people to be extra vigilant.

WEATHER · UK

2 Exciting news from the world of medicine, as the UK begins trials for an Ebola vaccine developed in just eight weeks.

The experimental vaccine has been given the green light by the UK medicines regulator and will now be tested on healthy adults. This rapid development is a testament to scientific progress.

HEALTH · UK

3 The Home Secretary is expected to outline plans to deport a notorious grooming gang leader, following public outcry.

Calls have mounted for Shabir Ahmed, the ringleader of the Rochdale grooming gang, to be deported after his release from prison. The government is now responding to these demands.

CRIME · UK

4 A former top government official is taking legal action after being sacked from his role earlier this year.

The official was fired in April following controversy surrounding Lord Mandelson's vetting process for the UK's ambassador to the US. This case could bring more details to light.

POLITICS · UK

5 Police forces across the UK are set to receive an additional £250 million to enhance safety in Jewish communities.

The extra funding aims to increase protection and security measures in response to growing concerns. This move highlights the government's commitment to community safety.

COMMUNITY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Good news for aspiring musicians! Ed Sheeran is inspiring a new government-backed scheme to bring music into libraries.**

The pop superstar will help design a programme that aims to put rehearsal spaces and studios into local libraries. Imagine learning to play in your local library!

ON AIR – What instrument would you love to learn if you had a free rehearsal space?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2 Reading Festival is looking to extend its main stage music to a fourth day, potentially adding more acts to the line-up.**

Currently, Wednesdays and Thursdays are considered warm-up days, but this change could mean more live music for festival-goers. It's great news for fans of the iconic festival!

ON AIR – Would you welcome an extra day of music at festivals, or is three days enough?

FESTIVAL · COMING UP
- 3 Midge Ure and Jim Kerr are among the stars backing plans to create a Scottish Rock and Roll Hall of Fame.**

The proposed museum would be housed at Glasgow's Centre for Contemporary Arts, celebrating Scotland's rich musical heritage. It's an exciting prospect for music fans north of the border.

ON AIR – Which Scottish music legend absolutely HAS to be in the Hall of Fame?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 Sam Fender and Olivia Dean have made UK chart history with their collaboration, 'Rein Me In'.**

The duo has broken the record for the longest-running number one single of all time by a British act. It's a fantastic achievement for both artists and a massive hit with fans!

ON AIR – What's your favourite musical collaboration of all time?

MUSIC · NOW
- 5 Pitbull fans have set a new Guinness World Record, with 22,000 people wearing bald caps at a recent event.**

The 'Mr. Worldwide' faithful gathered to break the record for the largest gathering of people wearing bald caps. It sounds like a truly unique and fun spectacle!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual world record attempt you've ever heard of?

EVENT · NOW

On the schedule

1 Jannik Sinner has successfully defended his Wimbledon title, beating Alexander Zverev in a thrilling final.

The world number one came from a set down to win in four sets on Centre Court. It was a fantastic display of tennis and a fitting end to the tournament.

ON AIR – Where does Jannik Sinner rank among the greatest tennis players of recent years?

TENNIS · UK

2 New Chelsea manager Xabi Alonso has been unveiled at Stamford Bridge and is keen to keep Enzo Fernandez at the club.

Alonso expressed his desire to retain the talented midfielder as he begins his tenure at Chelsea. It's a clear statement of intent from the new boss.

ON AIR – Do you think Xabi Alonso is the right man to lead Chelsea forward?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 Wales captain Dewi Lake is set to miss his country's Nations Championship match against world champions South Africa this Saturday.

It will be Lake's first game missed under coach Steve Tandy, which is a big blow for the Welsh side. They'll have a tough challenge ahead without their skipper.

ON AIR – How big a loss will Dewi Lake be for Wales against South Africa?

RUGBY · UK

4 India have completed a historic Test victory over England in the women's match at Lord's.

Sneh Rana took the final wicket to seal a commanding 270-run win for India. It was a memorable performance in what was a significant Test match.

ON AIR – What does this historic win mean for women's Test cricket?

CRICKET · UK

5 Last Chance Qualifier winner Joe Dean is on the hunt for accommodation for The Open, joking he might have to sleep in his car!

Dean secured his spot at Royal Birkdale after winning the inaugural qualifier, and now faces the challenge of finding somewhere to stay. What a story for the local lad!

ON AIR – What's the most extreme thing you've done to attend a major sporting event?

GOLF · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people creating 'miniature wildlife ponds' in their gardens, even in small spaces.**
These charming little oases, often made from old washing-up bowls or containers, are proving a hit for attracting frogs, newts, and insects, boosting local biodiversity with minimal effort.
- 2 The simple joy of 'sketching local landmarks' is becoming a popular pastime, with many taking to their high streets with pencils and paper.**
It's a lovely way to observe the architectural details we often rush past and connect with the history of our towns and villages in a new, creative way.
- 3 A recent study suggests that listening to 'comforting household sounds' like a gently humming fridge or a distant lawnmower can actually reduce stress.**
It seems these familiar, non-threatening background noises create a sense of calm and routine, offering a soothing backdrop to our busy lives.
- 4 The forgotten art of 'writing with a fountain pen' is experiencing a delightful revival amongst those seeking a more mindful writing experience.**
Many are rediscovering the elegant flow of ink and the tactile pleasure of putting pen to paper, making everyday notes feel a little more special.
- 5 A charming movement encouraging people to 'adopt a street plant pot' and care for it is brightening up urban areas.**
Neighbours are sharing watering duties and choosing colourful blooms, turning previously drab pavements into vibrant, welcoming spaces.
- 6 New research indicates that spending just a few minutes 'watching clouds drift by' can significantly improve creativity and reduce feelings of being overwhelmed.**
It encourages a gentle focus and allows the mind to wander freely, offering a simple yet effective way to de-stress and spark imagination.
- 7 The delightful practice of 'swapping homemade jams and preserves' with friends and neighbours is fostering community spirit.**
It's a delicious way to share seasonal produce and recipes, turning surplus fruit into lovely gifts and strengthening local bonds.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'lucky item of clothing' they absolutely have to wear for important events. What's their go-to lucky charm?

ANSWER: THEIR LUCKY SOCKS!

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'rearranging' what in someone else's house if it's slightly out of place, even though we know we shouldn't?

ANSWER: THEIR CUSHIONS!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do to make a trip to the local market or shops a bit more enjoyable, don't we?**

Do you have a particular route you always take, a favourite stall you visit first, or a special treat you always buy? Tell us about your market day traditions!

- **You know how sometimes you hear a 'word or phrase' from your childhood that nobody seems to use anymore, and it instantly takes you back?**

What's a forgotten word or saying from your younger days that you still love to use, even if it gets you a few puzzled looks? Give us a call!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Plants.** Bamboo is technically a type of grass, and some species can grow up to 3 feet in a single day, making it one of the fastest-growing plants on Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Tomatoes were once widely believed to be poisonous in Europe due to their close resemblance to the deadly nightshade plant, and were only eaten by the very brave.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's oldest known living tree, a Great Basin bristlecone pine named Methuselah, is over 4,800 years old.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The first recorded game of baseball was played in England in 1749, not America.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.

On this day

Day 195 of the year, 170 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Angeline of Marsciano; Christian feast day: Gaspar de Bono; Christian feast day: Camillus of Lellis (Roman Catholic Church, except in the United States); Christian feast day: Deusdedit of Canterbury. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — Bob Casale, American musician, member of Devo (died 2014)
- 1950 — Andy Newmark, American session and touring drummer (Carly Simon, George Harrison; John Lennon)
- 1940 — Susan Howatch, English author and academic
- 1932 — Rosey Grier, American football player and actor
- 1945 — Jim Gordon, American rock drummer and convicted murderer (died 2023)
- 1928 — Nancy Olson, American actress
- 1960 — Jane Lynch, American actress (Glee), comedian, author, and game show host
- 1923 — Dale Robertson, American actor (died 2013)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — Northwest Orient Airlines Flight 1-11 ditches off Polillo Island in the Philippines, killing one person and injuring 44.
- 1948 — Palmiro Togliatti, leader of the Italian Communist Party, is shot and wounded near the Italian Parliament.
- 2016 — A man ploughs a truck into a Bastille Day celebration in Nice, France, killing 86 people and injuring another 434 before being shot by police.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1942 — In the Wardha session of Congress, the "Quit India" resolution is approved, authorising Mahatma Gandhi to campaign for India's independence from Britain.
- 1983 — Mario Bros. is released in Japan, beginning the popular Super Mario Bros franchise.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2016 — A man ploughs a truck into a Bastille Day celebration in Nice, France, killing 86 people and injuring another 434 before being shot by police.

- 1881 — American outlaw Billy the Kid is shot and killed by Sheriff Pat Garrett in the Maxwell House at Fort Sumner, New Mexico.
- 1900 — Armies of the Eight-Nation Alliance capture Tientsin during the Boxer Rebellion.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 196 of the year, 169 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abhai (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Anne-Marie Javouhey; Christian feast day: Bernhard II, Margrave of Baden-Baden; Christian feast day: Bonaventure. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — Terry O'Quinn, American actor
- 1973 — Brian Austin Green, American actor
- 1935 — Alex Karras, American football player, wrestler, and actor (died 2012)
- 1944 — Millie Jackson, American singer-songwriter
- 1977 — Ray Toro, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1981 — Taylor Kinney, American actor
- 1968 — Eddie Griffin, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1958 — Gary Heale, English footballer and coach

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1971 — The United Red Army is founded in Japan.
- 1983 — An attack at Orly Airport in Paris is launched by Armenian militant organisation ASALA, leaving eight people dead and 55 injured.
- 2016 — Factions of the Turkish Armed Forces attempt a coup.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1888 — The stratovolcano Mount Bandai erupts, killing approximately 500 people in Fukushima Prefecture, Japan.
- 2006 — Twitter, later one of the largest social media platforms in the world, is launched.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
		FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)